

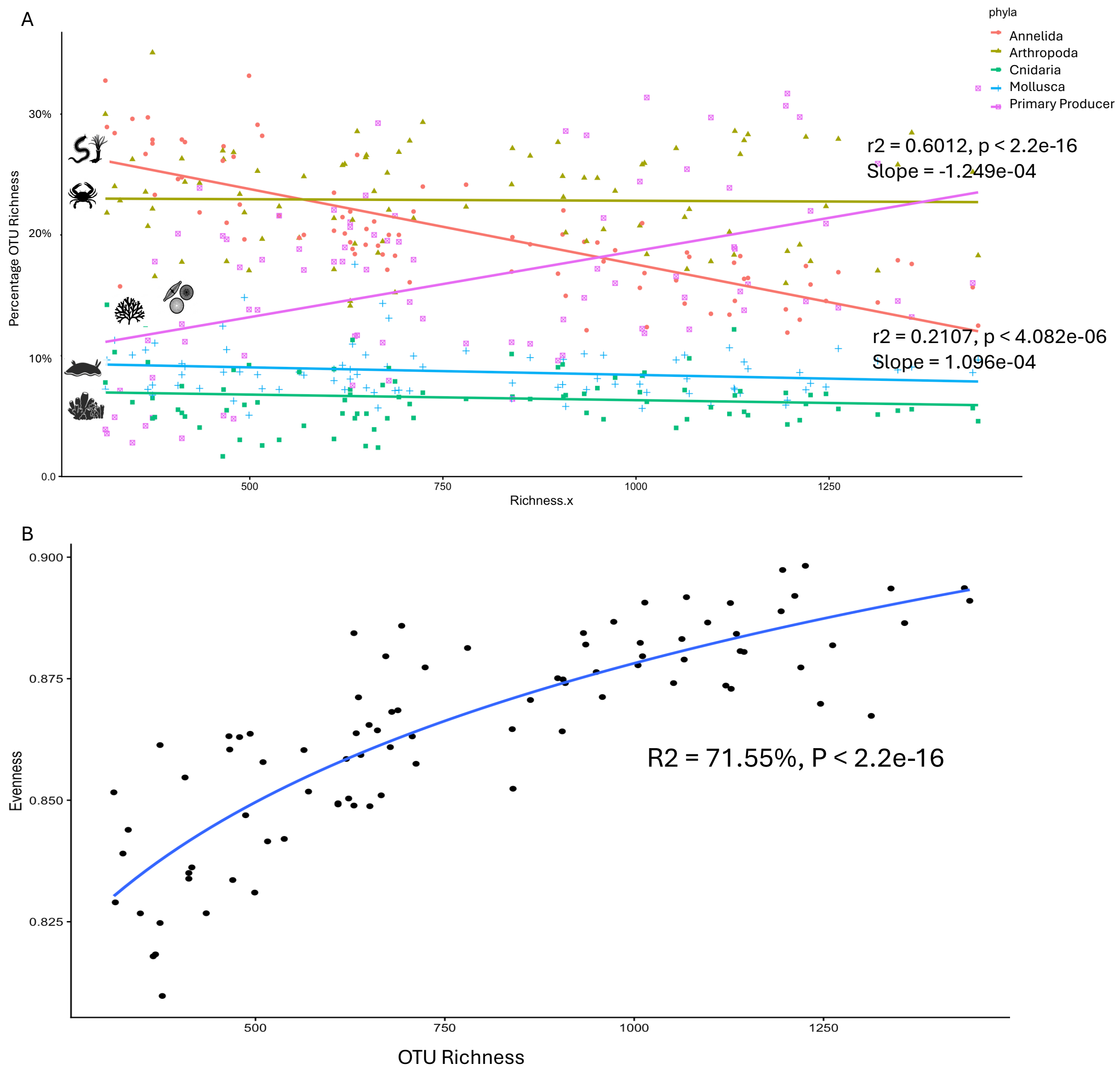


Figure 2: Changes in phylum-specific relative dominance across increasing OTU richness (A). Each point represents a community, with colors representing different phyla. Only Arthropoda and the primary producer (PP, Bacillariophyta and Rhodophyta) group showed statistically significant trends, with Arthropoda decreasing and PP increasing as OTU richness increases. Bacillariophyta and Rhodophyta are presented together as PP because their individual regression lines were nearly identical and overlapping. Relationship between community evenness (Pielou's evenness index) and OTU richness (B). Evenness were significantly correlated with OTU richness, suggesting that richer communities tend to be more evenly distributed among taxa